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PERSONAL PROFILE

First Class BSc (Hons) Computing graduate (Arden University, 2025), studied in the evenings across four years without taking time off work. My final-year project — a role-based events portal in PHP and MySQL — was graded First Class and scores 100 for accessibility in Lighthouse. A storefront I built for a decorations business has been live on its own domain since August 2026.

Before this, thirteen years in retail and warehouse management, eight of them running a BILLA supermarket with 40+ staff and its monthly budget. No commercial development experience yet — what I have is graded, tested and running, and I would rather say which is which than have someone find out in an interview.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Comfortable — HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Tailwind CSS, PHP, MySQL, SQL

Working in — React, Vite, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Git, GitHub, GSAP

From the degree, graded but not commercial — Java (OOP), Python for data science (pandas, scikit-learn), Azure (App Service, VNet, MySQL Flexible Server), Oracle APEX, XAMPP

Learning now — TypeScript, Next.js, PostgreSQL, ORMs, REST API design

PROJECTS

Moss Decorations — storefront

Live since Aug 2026

mossart.spireforge.co.uk

[React 19](#) · [Vite](#) · [Tailwind CSS](#) · [Express](#) · [MongoDB](#) · [Vitest](#)

- Built and shipped independently from brief to production for a preserved-moss decorations business; deployed as a Cloudflare Worker on its own domain.
- Five routes, each its own chunk. Filtering and sorting held in the URL, so a filtered view can be shared and the back button undoes it.
- 196 tests across 33 files, including a colour-contrast check that computes ratios from the design tokens and fails the build below the WCAG floor.
- The Express API is half-built: authentication works, the product and order routes are still stubs.

Manchester Event Portal — final-year project

First Class · 2025

Repository private as assessed coursework

[PHP](#) · [MySQL](#) · [Tailwind CSS](#) · [PDO](#) · [PHPMailer](#)

- An events platform for three roles — visitors, organisers and admins — each with its own dashboard, built across the full SDLC from requirements gathering to testing.
- 125 PHP files in a strict controller/model/view split; every query a prepared PDO statement, passwords hashed with bcrypt at cost 12, sessions hardened with strict mode, regeneration and a 30-minute timeout.
- Favourites, notifications, audit logging, image uploads, and a scheduled job that emails users before an event they saved.
- Tested rather than assumed: axe and WAVE for accessibility, Lighthouse for performance — 100 accessibility, 84 performance, zero layout shift.

WorldQuiz

Level 6 coursework, being rebuilt

github.com/STL73/WorldQuiz

[PHP](#) · [MySQL](#) · [JavaScript](#) · [CSS](#)

- A geography quiz over 46 landmarks with a token economy, server-side progress and role-gated admin dashboards for managing questions and users.
- Three-layer architecture with account creation and user/admin roles; deployed on the university's hosting. Currently being redesigned.

Personal portfolio

2026

spireforge.co.uk · github.com/STL73/MyPortfolio

React 19 · Vite · Tailwind v4 · GSAP

- Designed and built against a self-authored design system, with self-hosted subsetting fonts and everything below the fold code-split behind a Suspense boundary.
- GSAP scroll animations that respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computing — First Class

2021 – 2025

Arden University, Manchester · Overall mark 77.7

- **Level 6** — Computing Project (the events portal above), Web Application Development, Distributed and Cloud Computing (Azure App Service, virtual network with private endpoints and network security groups), Data Mining (Python: linear regression and Random Forest), Managing Innovation and Change.
- **Level 5** — Object-Oriented Programming in Java, Advanced Databases (MySQL: views, stored procedures, triggers, transactions), System Analysis and Design, Data Analysis and Visualisation, Human Computer Interaction, IT Project Management (PRINCE2).
- **Level 4** — Web Authoring, Programming in Java, Databases (Oracle APEX), Computer Systems and Security.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Warehouse Operative

Jun 2018 – Present

Great Bear Distribution — Salford, Manchester

- Consistently met daily throughput targets in a high-volume logistics environment.
- Operated scanning and inventory systems with a low error rate across high daily transaction volumes.
- Adapted reliably to rotating shifts and changing priorities without disruption to output.

Store Manager

Aug 2008 – Aug 2016

BILLA Bulgaria — Varna, Bulgaria

- Managed 40+ staff across all departments: scheduling, performance reviews and daily operations.
- Controlled the monthly operations budget, identifying and resolving financial discrepancies to deliver positive results.
- Opened a new store location from the ground up — recruited and trained staff, and oversaw full operational setup.
- Turned customer complaints and process breakdowns into lasting operational improvements.

Department Manager

Jun 2006 – Jul 2008

KAUFLAND Bulgaria — Varna, Bulgaria

- Managed 10 direct reports, coaching performance and keeping the team aligned with sales and profit targets.
- Built daily and weekly sales plans from trend data, working closely with the wider management team.
- Managed inventory and receiving operations to maintain stock levels and meet expected demand.

CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

Forklift Trucks Licence (PPT, VNA, Counterbalance) · Full UK Driving Licence · Arden Achieve Award, Arden University (2023)

English — professional working proficiency · **Bulgarian** — native